

# WRITING

## an article (II)

### Discuss the topic

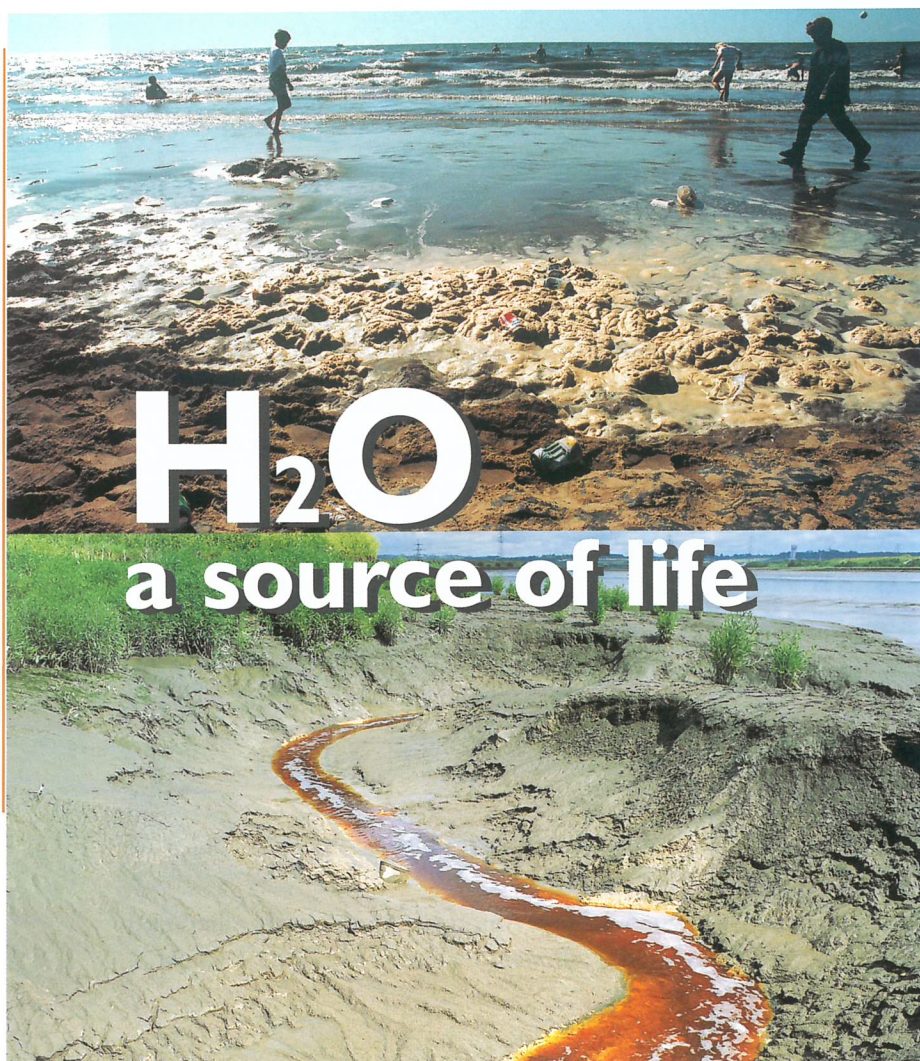
- What do you know about water pollution?

### Sample writing

- Below is an article investigating the following question:

*Does water pollution affect our lives?*

Read the article. What are the effects of water pollution mentioned in this article?



**H**ow often do you think about water? Probably only when you're thirsty or need a bath. However, in our everyday life, water pollution is a serious problem.

Next time you drink a glass of water, stop and think. In some places, drinking water is polluted and as a result people become seriously ill or have even died. To make sure that water is clean, people buy water filters or simply boil it.

Furthermore, polluted beaches have caused many problems in recent years. Numerous people have suffered infections or developed allergies after swimming at a polluted beach. Nowadays, beaches must be inspected and declared safe enough for swimming.

And what about marine life? Not only do sea animals and plants suffer from water pollution, but people do, too. People have been poisoned by eating contaminated seafood. Fortunately, measures have been taken to avoid incidents like this.

Whether we choose to think about it or not, water pollution affects our everyday life. How much longer are we going to continue polluting our seas, rivers and lakes before we realise it's too late?

- What is the topic of each paragraph in the article above? Write your answers below.

Paragraph 1 \_\_\_\_\_

Paragraph 2 \_\_\_\_\_

Paragraph 3 \_\_\_\_\_

Paragraph 4 \_\_\_\_\_

Paragraph 5 \_\_\_\_\_



## Plan

An article is usually written for a newspaper or magazine. This unit deals with articles in which you are asked to state your opinion, make suggestions on a topic or give information about it. Below is a plan for an article of this type, with questions to guide you.

|                                      |                                                                                   |                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Headline</b>                      | • write an interesting headline                                                   |                                                                                                               |
| <b>Introduction</b>                  | • introduce the topic in such a way that you catch the reader's attention         | <i>What are you going to discuss?<br/>How can you make the introduction interesting?</i>                      |
| <b>Main part</b><br>(2-3 paragraphs) | • present your ideas (opinions/suggestions/solutions)<br>• include relevant facts | <i>What are your ideas/views?<br/>How do you justify your ideas/views?<br/>What suggestions can you make?</i> |
| <b>Conclusion</b>                    | • conclude by summarising your points<br>• close with a general comment/opinion   | <i>What is your overall opinion?</i>                                                                          |

## Guide to writing

- Make sure you understand the topic and know exactly what to write about.
- Before you start, try to come up with ideas and make a plan of what you are going to write.
- Choose a few of your ideas/points (the ones you have a lot to say about) and expand on them.
- Write an original headline and an interesting introduction that will catch the reader's attention and will make him/her want to continue reading.
- Don't just mention your points when writing the article. Always justify your ideas and, if possible, use examples to explain what you mean.
- Use the Passive Voice to write in an impersonal way or use the personal pronoun *you* to be more direct.
- Divide your article into paragraphs and have a separate paragraph for every major point.
- Use a topic sentence at the beginning of each paragraph. This sentence introduces the central idea of the paragraph. The other sentences in the paragraph develop the idea presented in the topic sentence.
- Don't present any new ideas in the conclusion.
- Use different techniques to make the article more interesting. Ask questions, include exclamation marks and use a variety of words and expressions.

- Use linking words/phrases to make the article flow. Look at the table for ideas.

|                                         |                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>listing points</b>                   | firstly, first of all, to begin/start with, secondly, finally                                          |
| <b>giving additional information</b>    | in addition (to this), furthermore, moreover, also, apart from this, besides, what is more, as well as |
| <b>giving an example</b>                | for example, such as                                                                                   |
| <b>emphasising</b>                      | in fact, as a matter of fact                                                                           |
| <b>expressing result or consequence</b> | therefore, in this case, for this reason, as a result                                                  |



## Writing practice

1. Below is an article which suggests ways of protecting endangered species. Read the article carefully. The topic sentence from each paragraph is missing. Choose five of the sentences A-F below and match them with the appropriate paragraph 1-5 in the article.

# wildlife dying

**1** \_\_\_\_\_ Obviously, we're not doing enough to protect them. So, don't you think it's about time we became more serious about protecting wildlife?

**2** \_\_\_\_\_ We shouldn't destroy or pollute the natural habitats of animals. Animals need their natural habitat to survive. Instead of cutting down forests, we should plant new ones and try to reduce pollution as much as possible.

**3** \_\_\_\_\_ These places are called National Parks. Here hunting is banned and the public is usually not allowed to enter. However, not enough National Parks exist.

**4** \_\_\_\_\_ In fact, in a number of countries it is illegal to kill or capture animals that are considered rare or threatened.

However, in some places, hunters continue to hunt, even though this is against the law. Therefore, stricter laws must be introduced.

**5** \_\_\_\_\_ What a difference it would make if all of us co-operated to protect wildlife.



**A** In some parts of the world there are places where both animals and their habitats are protected.

**B** To sum up, there are various ways in which endangered species can be protected.

**C** It is too late to repair the damage we've done.

**D** Of course, there are laws which protect endangered species.

**E** We all know that more and more animals are placed on the endangered species list every year.

**F** Let's begin with what we shouldn't do.



2. a. Below is the introduction to an article investigating the question:  
*How can people in your neighbourhood help protect the environment?*  
Rewrite the introduction so that it flows better and is more interesting.



Everyone must protect the environment. This is important. Ordinary people can do many things to help in their neighbourhood. You don't have to change your lifestyle a lot. This is what you can do.

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

- b. Make a plan for the main part of the article above. Then write the paragraphs of the main part in the space provided.

*Plan*

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---



---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

- c. Now read the three closing paragraphs below. Which would be the most appropriate for the article? Why aren't the other two appropriate?

**A** I'll never forget living in that neighbourhood. After that event everyone worked together to make our neighbourhood clean and beautiful.

**B** In conclusion, it is clear that everyone can help to protect the environment, and they can start by keeping their neighbourhood clean. If everyone made an effort, we would definitely live in a much cleaner world.

**C** It's obvious then that everyone can take part in helping protect the environment. So, why not promote environmental awareness in your neighbourhood? It will not only help the environment, but it will also make your area more pleasant to live in.

3. Task for homework.  
Your school newspaper has invited you to write an article suggesting ways in which different types of pollution can be reduced in your town/city. Write your article. (120-180 words)